Printed Pages – 13

576312 (76)
676312 (76)

MBA (3rd Semester)

Examination, Nov.-Dec., 2013

Branch : Management

ORGANIZATIONAL DEVELOPMENT (NEW)

Time Allowed : Three Hours

Maximum Marks : 80

Minimum Pass Marks : 32

Note : Attempt the questions as per instructions against each.

Section - A

Attempt question number (one), compulsorily & from 2 & 3 any one.

Q. 1. Define organization development. Explain why organization development would be necessary even in a stable environment. 1×6=6

Q. 2. "People in organisation work in groups (teams) and the effective working of this group determines organisational effectiveness." Explain. 10

Or

Q. 3. Give a detailed note on the factors influencing in designing the organisational structure. 10

Section - B

Attempt any two questions from the following :

Q. 1. What is OD interventions ? Describe the various OD interventions and explain as to how they improve the functioning of the organisation. 8

Or

Q. 2. What are the various types of change agents ? Describe the nature of the organisational environment in which each change agent would be more effective. 8

Or

Q. 3. What are the reasons for resistance to change ? What can the management do to overcome such resistance ? 8

Section - C

Answer any two :

Q. 1. What is conflict ? Explain the sources of conflict ? How conflict is resolved ? 8

Or

Q. 2. Explain the concept of cross cultural dynamics ? 8

Or

Q. 3. Role of transactional analysis in resolving group conflict. 8

Section - D

Q. 1. Define the process of managerial grid in detail. 6

Or

Short notes (any 2) : 6

(a) Intervention mechanism

(b) Creativity in organisation

(c) Diagnosis activities

(d) Power and politics

Q. 2. A well established unit manufacturing readymade garments plans to introduce and new methods and methods of production. The workers in the factory numbering on 150 are fearful of the change resisting it in many ways. What actions will you advise the management to take to solve the problem ? 10

Section - E

Case Study : 16

George A. Hormel & Company has many meat packing plants around the country and one of these plants is located at Austin, Minnesota. During the mid 1980s, the company was faced with a decreasing demand for its products. It became necessary to cut the costs of operations in order to remain in business and be competitive. To keep its costs down, the management of the company cut the base wages of its union employees. This

was done arbitrarily and without consulting or negotiating with the union representatives. Even though the dispute between the union and the management had been simmering for a long time at the plant in Austin, it culminated in a strike led by the union in August of 1985.

An arbitrator was appointed to act as a mediator and due to his recommendation, some of the cuts in wages were restored. The management offered to restore the balance of the cuts at the time when the previous labour contract

would expire and a new contract would be signed. The new contact was signed by all the unions at all other Hormel plants, except the one in Austin, and hence the strike. Because of the worker's strike, the plant was shut down.

The plant remained closed for nearly five months. The strike had not yet been settled when the management at the Austin plant decided to reopen the plant, and accordingly, some union members returned to work. Many other workers refused to return to work and formed a picket line

and the local union urged its members not to cross the picket line. The management started to hire new workers to replace those who were on strike. There was conflict between the employees and the workers on strike, so much so, that at one time there was a danger of physical violence and local police had to be called in to restrain the workers who were on strike.

The local union sent some of its members to picket other Hormel plants and asked the union members at these other plants to honour the

picket lines and not report for work. About a week after the Austin plant was reopened, the central management fired hundreds of their workers at plants in Texas, Iowa and Nebraska for refusing to cross the picket lines and refusing to report for work. This step was significant because picket lines at the other plants were not set up by the local employees but by the striking employees at the plant in Austin.

The strike at the plant in Austin went into ninth month. Tempers flared and violence erupted and in May 1986 hundreds of strikers fought with police outside the Austin plant. The parent union, United Food and Commercial Workers union also disagreed with the striking workers prompted by the local union, considering the economic slowdown and conditions in the industry. The President of the parent union decided to take over the operations of the local union and started proceedings to appoint a new union leadership at

P.T.O.

this plant. He believed that the conflict had gone too far and he hoped that with these changes, the strike would be over and the workers could go back to work.

Questions :

(i) Given the condition of economic slump, do you think the workers were wrong in going on strike ? Give reasons.

(ii) Is the conflict between union and management inevitable ? What preventive steps can be taken to avoid the possibility of worker strike ? Explain your viewpoints.

(iii) Who were the winners and who were the losers in this conflict ?

(iv) If you were hired as a mediator, after the union went on strike, what step would you recommend in order to minimize the negative impact on this conflict ?